

Problem Statement

Ideation Phase | Import Data Using Transform Maps

1. Background

Organisations that run ServiceNow regularly need to bring in data from outside sources such as HR spreadsheets, asset inventories, legacy ticketing tools and vendor files. This data usually arrives as CSV or Excel files with column names and values that do not match the ServiceNow table structure. ServiceNow provides **Import Sets** and **Transform Maps** to solve this, but many teams do not use them well and fall back on manual entry.

2. Problem Statement

Admins and data owners need a reliable way to load external data into ServiceNow tables, but manual entry and ad-hoc uploads lead to duplicates, wrong field values, missing references and no audit trail. This costs time, reduces data quality and breaks reports and workflows that depend on that data.

3. Problem Statement Canvas

Element	Description
I am	A ServiceNow administrator / developer responsible for data quality
I'm trying to	Load large files of users, assets or tickets into the correct ServiceNow tables
But	Columns do not match field names, values need cleaning, and re-uploads create duplicate records
Because	Data is entered or uploaded without a defined mapping, unique key or validation
Which makes me feel	Frustrated, uncertain about accuracy, and worried about the effect on reports

4. Root Cause Analysis (5 Whys)

Why?	Answer
Why is imported data inaccurate?	Values are copied by hand or loaded without mapping rules
Why are there no mapping rules?	Teams are unaware of or unsure how to configure Transform Maps
Why do duplicates appear?	No coalesce (unique key) field is defined, so each load inserts new rows
Why are errors found late?	Transform history and import logs are not reviewed after each run
Why does it repeat each time?	The process is not standardised or documented

5. Impact of the Problem

- **Time:** hours spent on manual entry and cleanup for each data load.
- **Quality:** duplicate users, assets or incidents distort CMDB and reports.
- **Risk:** wrong department or assignment group values route work incorrectly.
- **Audit:** no record of who loaded what and when.

- **Scalability:** manual methods fail as data volume grows.

6. Who Is Affected

Stakeholder	How they are affected
Administrators	Spend time fixing bad data and repeating loads
Data owners	Cannot trust that their data was loaded correctly
End users / fulfillers	Get wrong or duplicate records in their queues
Management	Receive unreliable dashboards and reports

7. Desired Outcome

- Data loaded in minutes through a repeatable import process.
- Source columns mapped correctly to target fields every time.
- No duplicates, because existing records are matched and updated.
- Every run logged and reviewable for errors.